

Ridgeline HD lower control arm may fracture causing loss of control

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Area: recalls

1 Defect Description

Certain Ridgeline HD trucks were built with a lower control arm assembly, part number CARM-8540, that contains a forging void at the ball-joint boss. Under repeated heavy-load articulation the void can propagate into a crack and ultimately fracture the control arm. Because the arm shares mounting geometry with the wheel hub bearing assembly WHB-8580, a fracture also unseats the bearing and produces severe wheel misalignment. See the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Control Arms and Sway Bar Links for the affected geometry and the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Wheel Hub Bearing Assembly for the coupled hub interface.

2 Safety Risk and Affected Vehicles

A fracture of CARM-8540 while the vehicle is in motion can cause sudden loss of steering control and a road-departure crash without warning. The condition is most likely under towing or full-payload conditions where articulation loads peak. Affected vehicles are Ridgeline HD units within the identified production window; refer to the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual and the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Suspension System Overview to confirm the suspension configuration before inspection.

3 Remedy

Dealers will replace the lower control arm CARM-8540 with a re-forged part free of charge following procedure PROC-CONTROL-ARM, and will inspect the adjacent wheel hub bearing assembly WHB-8580 for collateral damage. Perform the replacement per the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Control Arm Replacement Procedure , and if the hub shows play replace it using the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Wheel Hub Bearing Replacement Procedure . Owners can verify recall status and remedy availability at <https://www.nhtsa.gov/recalls> before scheduling service.